

May Salama, BDS, MPH, CPH

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EDUCATION

08-2022 – Current	Health Services Research Ph.D., Health Policy and Management (ABD) (GPA-3.71) Old Dominion University, Norfolk, Virginia
08-2019 – 05-2021	Master of Public Health, Epidemiology (GPA-4.0) Eastern Virginia Medical School, Norfolk, Virginia
08-2008 – 07-2013	Bachelor of Oral and Dental Surgery (with Honors) October University for Modern Sciences and Arts, Cairo, Egypt

ADVANCED EDUCATION AND PROFESSIONAL TRAINING

09-2024 – Current	Maternal and Child Health Mentorship Program American Association of Public Health
09-2024 – Current	Dental Public Health Leadership Academy Fellowship American Institute of Dental Public Health
09-2024 – 06-2025	Student Leadership Program in Global Oral Health Alliance for Oral Health Across Borders
07-2021 – 06-2022	Dental Public Health Residency North Carolina Department of Health and Human Services, Raleigh, North Carolina
10-2014 – 06-2016	Pediatric Dentistry Residency Faculty of Dentistry at Cairo University, Cairo, Egypt
10-2013 – 09-2014	Internship Training in General Dentistry Faculty of Dentistry at Cairo University, Cairo, Egypt

HONORS & AWARDS

- Featured by Old Dominion University for Research Achievements in Maternal Health ([Article](#))
- The American Association of Public Health Dentistry (AAPHD) Grant Award
- Research Recognition and Travel Award for AADMD Conference, Alliance for Oral Health Across Borders
- The Dr. Deanne Shuman Endowed Scholarship in Health Services, Old Dominion University
- Graduate Student Travel Grant Award for APHA Conference, Old Dominion University
- Graduate Student Summer Grant Award, Old Dominion University
- Member of the Delta Omega Alpha Kappa Chapter Honorary Society in Public Health
- Old Dominion University Graduate Research Assistantship
- Harvard Medical School Merit-based Scholarship for Foundations of Clinical Research
- Anti-Hunger Advocate Scholarship, Food Research & Action Center
- ICON Scholarship for Premier World Congress on Dental Research & Future Dentistry

WORK EXPERIENCE (UNITED STATES)

08-2022 – Current	Graduate Research Assistant Old Dominion University, Norfolk, Virginia • Led and supported research initiatives focused on maternal and child health, oral health, perinatal mental health, and health equity, contributing to multiple projects spanning clinical, behavioral, and policy domains.
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- Served as a peer reviewer for academic journals, including *BMC Pediatrics* and *BMC Public Health*.
- Conducted advanced data analysis using national datasets such as PRAMS, NHANES, and MEPS.
- Prepared and delivered scientific presentations, abstracts, and research posters at national and university-level conferences.
- Assisted in grant writing efforts by developing research narratives and analytic strategies focused on oral health disparities, maternal health, and health policy interventions.
- Collaborated with interdisciplinary faculty mentors and research teams to translate study findings into actionable recommendations for advancing maternal and child health equity.

06-2024 – 08-2024

Dental Public Health Advocacy Fellow

American Institute of Dental Public Health Summer Advocacy Fellowship, Remote

- Developed a database of policy resources related to Medicaid oral health coverage for adults with disabilities for state-based stakeholders.

05-2024 – 07-2024

Maternal and Child Health Intern

Virginia Department of Health Internship Academy, Chesapeake, Virginia

- Analyzed data for the 2018-2023 Baby Care Study of Births.
- Developed a standardized training manual for the Baby Care program.
- Conducted home visits to educate parents on proper infant care and provide parents in need with essential items for newborns.

05-2022 – 08-2022

Public Health Scientist and Scientific Writer

We Rise 4 Wellness Inc. Summer Internship Program, Remote

- Conducted research to support projects that address diverse public health, education, and community topics, including healthcare access, school safety, mental health, social determinants, youth development, and oral health-related quality of life.
- Designed and revised surveys to evaluate the effectiveness, accessibility, and quality of personal and population-based health services.

11-2021 – 06-2022

Lecturer and Teaching Assistant

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill and East Carolina University, North Carolina

- Delivered lectures on maternal and child oral health, dental policy, and health disparities to undergraduate students.
- Assisted with course preparation, facilitated in-class learning, graded assignments, and provided constructive feedback to support student development.

06-2021 – 07-2021

Intern to Support Dental Care

Changing the Present nonprofit Organization, Remote

- Identified and invited nonprofits that can register and list their charitable gifts at no cost.
- Researched magazines, websites, professional organizations, and online communities to reach people who care about dental and oral health care.

10-2020 – 05-2021

Graduate Research Assistant

Portsmouth Diabetes Prevention Program, Portsmouth, Virginia

- Participated in a Quality Improvement project that surveyed patients at EVMS Portsmouth Family Medicine and Bon Secours Mary View Emergency Department about food insecurity and other relevant information.
- Drafted research proposal for the Institutional Review Board.
- Managed and collected data on REDCap (Research Electronic Data Capture) hosted at Eastern Virginia Medical School.
- Developed online evidence-based training modules covering nutritional and behavioral aspects, which included a quiz at the end of each module to assess the understanding of key concepts.

06-2019 – 09-2020

Community Oral Health Initiative Intern

Brush, Book, Bed program of the American Academy of Pediatrics, Norfolk, Virginia

- Assisted in developing grant proposals for \$15,000 from the Virginia Oral Health Coalition to improve oral health in South Hampton Roads.
- Distributed the Brush, Book, Bed flyers to 4,282 Children in 39 childcare centers.
- Created a simple survey for parents to complete before BBB education and again 1 month later.
- Provided training for preschool teachers to help them with visiting parents in their homes.
- Completed 45-day screenings of dental homes to see children and parents for cleaning, varnishes, and other health needs.
- Worked with multiple organizations in the Hampton Roads area, including Loving Steps, Chesapeake Baby Care, Suffolk Healthy Families, HRHVA, DentaQuest, Heartland Dental, and Head Start Programs to distribute oral health lessons and dental supplies to kids and families.
- Advocated for addressing oral health access issues by increasing utilization of the Medicaid dental benefit for pregnant women and implementing policies that childcare centers can use to increase the number of children with dental homes.

05-2019 – 12-2019

Health Educator

Minus 9 to 5 Program of the Hampton Roads Community Foundation, Norfolk, Virginia

- Equipped families with the knowledge and resources to improve access to prenatal care and education for new parents.
- Aligned services and providers across the region to promote education, health, and social services for young children and their families.
- Shared data for internal and external audiences on the progress being made and on adopting best practices.
- Identified and advocated for policies that improve early care and education.

WORK EXPERIENCE (INTERNATIONAL)

11-2015 – 02-2016

Editorial Assistant

Egyptian Center for Women's Rights, Cairo, Egypt

- Handled queries, article acquisition, author communications, copyediting articles, and preparing them for publication.
- Assisted with spreadsheets and administrative duties.
- Performed a variety of editing, writing, and research.
- Supported duties to aid in the publication of materials.

06-2015 – 03-2016

Research Assistant

Egyptian Public Health Association, Cairo, Egypt

- Contributed to the development and implementation of an educational intervention aimed at improving oral health beliefs among pregnant women.
- Conducted data collection, analysis, and evaluation of intervention outcomes to assess changes in participants' oral health knowledge and practices.

02-2014 – 10-2014

Community-Based Activity Worker

Egyptian Food Bank: School Feeding Program, Cairo, Egypt

- Provided almost 12,000 meals to students in 10 schools on a daily basis.
- Educated the students and parents about the importance of healthy, nutritious meals.

07-2013 – 01-2014

Child Advocacy Assistant

Save the Children Organization, Cairo, Egypt

- Measured malnutrition among children under 5 years of age using various indicators, including stunting, wasting, underweight, anemia, and other food insecurity indicators.
- Assessed the needs of at-risk children and ensured they were accessing the right services and support by providing case management, counseling, and psychosocial support services.

PEER-REVIEW PUBLICATIONS

- **Salama, M.**, Al-Taïar, A., McKinney, D., Al Otaibi, S., Al-Sallum, S., Bawa, E. M., & Merchant, A. T. (2025). Unmeasured confounding in meta-analyses of observational studies evaluating maternal periodontitis and adverse birth outcomes. *Journal of Public Health*, fdaf056. <https://doi.org/10.1093/pubmed/fdaf056>
- Al-Taïar, A., Rahman, M. E., **Salama, M.**, Ziyab, A. H., & Karmaus, W. (2025). Impacts of Ramadan fasting during pregnancy on pregnancy and birth outcomes: An umbrella review. *International Journal of Gynecology & Obstetrics*. <https://doi.org/10.1002/ijgo.16127>
- **Salama, M.**, Al-Taïar, A., McKinney, D. C., Rahman, E., & Merchant, A. T. (2024). The impact of scaling and root planning combined with mouthwash during pregnancy on preterm birth and low birth weight: a systematic review and meta-analysis. *BMC Pregnancy and Childbirth*, 24(1), 726. <https://doi.org/10.1186/s12884-024-06905-1>

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER PEER-REVIEW

- Sharaf-Alddin, R. **Salama, M.**, Zhang, Q. Prenatal Exposure to Nicotine and Postpartum Depression: Systematic Review and Meta-Analysis. *Under review at Archives of Women's Mental Health*.
- Brown, E., **Salama, M.** Description of A Transparency Framework and SWOT Analysis for A Year-Long Healthcare Studies Practicum Focused on Public Health and Disparities Research. *Under review at PLOS One*.
- **Salama, M.**, Al-Taïar, A. Oral Healthcare Services Utilization among the Adult US Population from the Medical Expenditure Panel Survey 2021: A Cross-Sectional Study. *Under Review at BMC Public Health*.

PUBLIC HEALTH TRAINING PROGRAMS

10-2021 – 03-2022	Disaster Preparedness and Response The University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill
08-2021– 10-2021	Child Development: Behavior and Mental Health Stanford University
02-2021 – 04-2021	Maternal, Child, and Adolescent Health University of California, Berkley
10-2020 – 12-2020	Healthcare Management George Washington University
08-2020 – 11-2020	International Women's Health and Human Rights Stanford University
09-2020 – 10-2020	Understanding and Strengthening Health Systems Johns Hopkins University
07-2020 – 10-2020	Child Protection: Children's Rights in Theory and Practice Harvard University
11-2019 – 12-2019	Epidemics, Pandemics, and Outbreaks University of Pittsburgh
11-2018 – 12-2018	Leading Healthcare Quality and Safety George Washington University

SEMINARS & POSTERS PRESENTED

06-2025	Prevalence And Determinants of Preventive Dental Care Utilization Among Pregnant Women in Virginia: Findings from PRAMS American Academy of Developmental Medicine and Dentistry, Phoenix, Arizona
10-2024	The Impact of Scaling and Root Planning Combined with Mouthwash during Pregnancy on Preterm Birth and Low Birth Weight: A Systematic Review and Meta-Analysis American Public Health Association, Minneapolis, Minnesota
07-2024	Assessing the Impact of Participating in the BabyCare Home Visiting Program on Pregnancy and Birth Outcomes in Chesapeake Virginia Department of Health, Richmond, Virginia
06-2024	The Impact of Unmeasured Confounding on the Association between Maternal Periodontitis and Adverse Birth Outcomes: A Meta-Analysis of Observational Studies Society for Epidemiologic Research Meeting Conference, Austin, Texas
04-2023	Impact of Treating Maternal Periodontal Disease on the Risk of Preterm Birth and Low Birth Weight: Preliminary Findings of Umbrella Review College of Health Sciences Research Day, Old Dominion University, Norfolk, Virginia
04-2022	Oral Health During Pregnancy and the Prevalence of Preterm Birth and Low Birth Weight in Infants in North Carolina National Oral Health Conference, Fort Worth, Texas
11-2021	Food Insecurity and Access to Oral Health Care Kansas City University College of Dentistry “DPH and Oral Health Policy Course”
03-2021	Maternal and Early Childhood Oral Health North Carolina Department of Health and Human Services, Raleigh, North Carolina
11-2020	Ethical Framework for Global Vaccine Allocation Eastern Virginia Medical School, Norfolk, Virginia
10-2020	COVID-19 Transmission Before and After Relaxation of Social Measures Eastern Virginia Medical School, Norfolk, Virginia
07-2020	Herpes Zoster as A Risk Factor for Osteoporosis Eastern Virginia Medical School, Norfolk, Virginia
12-2019	Utilization of Medicaid Benefits for Pregnant Women The Consortium for Infant and Child Health (CINCH)

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE & COMMUNITY INVOLVEMENT

10-2018 – Current	Blood Donor Ambassador Volunteer Red Cross, Norfolk, Virginia
09-2018	Mobile Pantry and Quality Assurance Volunteer Food Bank, Norfolk, Virginia

LANGUAGES

- English
- Arabic

SOFTWARE

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| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Microsoft Office (PowerPoint, Word, Excel) • Statistical Software System (SAS) • R • SPSS • REDCap | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Tableau Public • SAS Studio • SurveyMonkey • EndNote |
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